

RESEARCH BRIEF: Background & Context

FitShare is evaluating three early-stage engagement directions: AI-driven personalised workout plans, live group workout sessions, and an integrated marketplace for fitness gear and supplements. The business trigger is the need to prioritise the product roadmap using evidence of genuine unmet needs rather than relying on novelty-driven feature appeal.

India provides a large addressable digital audience: DataReportal and Kepios report approximately 500 million active social-media user identities in India in October 2025, including approximately 455 million adult identities. (datareportal.com) At the same time, Deloitte's India Fitness Market Report 2025 estimates that the Indian fitness market could reach approximately INR 37,700 crore by 2030, with growth supported by hybrid models, technology, group exercise, and personalised wellness experiences. (hub.healthandfitness.org, deloitte.com)

The competitive context is already advanced. HealthifyMe offers AI-enabled coaching, personalised diet and workout plans, nutrition tracking, and personalised recommendations. (plans.healthifyme.com, plans.healthifyme.com, healthifyme.com) cult.fit provides live and on-demand workouts, progress reports, and the ability to work out with friends. (cult.fit, cult.fit) FitShare therefore needs to identify where it can create differentiated value, especially around trust, safety, accountability, meaningful social participation, and healthier engagement rather than simply adding more screen time.

Research Objectives

Based on the approved strategic framework, this study will address the following objectives.

Strategic Objectives:

1. Validate the strongest unmet needs in social fitness in order to prioritise FitShare's product roadmap.
2. Determine whether FitShare's opportunity is strongest in personalisation, accountability, community participation, commerce, or healthier digital engagement.

3. Assess the potential for FitShare to attract current users, competitor users, general fitness-content users, and people who have reduced or stopped using social media.
4. Identify the conditions required for users to trust and adopt AI recommendations, live group participation, and fitness-commerce recommendations.
5. Determine which feature should enter prototyping first and whether the marketplace belongs in the initial roadmap or a later monetisation phase.

Tactical Objectives:

1. Measure current social-media, fitness-platform, workout, content-consumption, tracking, and community-participation behaviours.
2. Map platform repertoires across FitShare, HealthifyMe, cult.fit, Strava, Instagram, YouTube, WhatsApp communities, and other relevant services.
3. Identify unmet needs and frustrations related to motivation, consistency, personalisation, accountability, notifications, privacy, comparison, content relevance, and screen time.
4. Quantify the incidence of reduced or lapsed social-media use and identify the reasons for reducing usage.
5. Evaluate each of the three feature concepts on appeal, relevance, usefulness, differentiation, ease of understanding, trust, FitShare fit, and likelihood of trial.
6. Validate whether AI workout plans are attractive only when they are personalised, explainable, adjustable, safe, and subject to user control.
7. Determine whether live group workouts create value primarily through accountability, coaching quality, social belonging, competition, convenience, or participation with friends.
8. Assess whether marketplace interest depends more on product availability, trust, relevance, transparent recommendations, price-value, and affiliate disclosure.
9. Measure desired privacy controls, notification settings, focus modes, content controls, and definitions of healthy engagement.
10. Identify switching barriers, substitution risks, and reasons competitor users may not move to FitShare.
11. Prioritise the three concepts through a final forced-choice roadmap exercise.
12. Segment users by fitness participation, social motivation, goal type, digital-wellbeing concern, AI comfort, willingness to join live sessions, and openness to purchasing fitness products online.

Type of Study

We will conduct a Mixed Methodology study combining Usage & Attitude, Feature/Message Prioritisation, and Concept Screening. This combination is appropriate because FitShare must first understand existing behaviour and unmet needs, then evaluate three discrete feature concepts, and finally force a realistic roadmap trade-off.

Survey Design Approach

The selected design is Sequential Monadic Concept Evaluation with a final forced prioritisation exercise, embedded within a linear Usage & Attitude questionnaire.

There are three discrete stimuli: AI-driven personalised workout plans, live group workout sessions, and an integrated fitness marketplace. Each respondent will see and evaluate all three concepts one at a time. The concept order will be rotated using a Latin Square approach so that no single idea benefits systematically from being shown first. Each concept will receive a concise, neutral, benefit-led description rather than polished product screens.

This approach fits the business decision because FitShare needs both an absolute diagnostic read on every idea and a final comparative decision about which idea deserves investment first. Sequential monadic evaluation limits direct comparison effects while remaining sample-efficient. The final forced-choice exercise will reveal the feature most likely to improve the FitShare experience, as well as the feature respondents are least likely to want.

Alternatives considered:

- Pure Monadic: Not chosen because three independent cells would require approximately 150-200 respondents per concept, increasing the total sample and fieldwork burden.
- Side-by-Side Comparative: Not chosen because respondents may over-reward the easiest concept to understand and provide weaker standalone diagnostic scores.
- MaxDiff: Not chosen because the current roadmap contains only three concepts; MaxDiff becomes more useful when prioritising five or more individual features, claims, or messages.

The U&A module will be completed before any concept exposure. Concept order will be rotated, high-value open-ended probes will follow key ratings, and the final prioritisation will create a forced trade-off. The questionnaire will remain smartphone-friendly and target approximately 20-25 questions over 8-12 minutes.

Survey Routing Logic:

- Skip Logic: Bypass irrelevant modules based on current platform use, fitness behaviour, AI comfort, live-session interest, and marketplace openness.
- Branching: Route current FitShare users, competitor users, lapsed social-media users, and general social-media users to relevant diagnostic paths.
- Display Logic: Show feature-specific follow-ups only when the respondent expresses sufficient interest or concern.
- Termination Logic: Exit respondents who fail the minimum social-media or fitness-behaviour eligibility criteria.
- Completion Logic: End the survey gracefully when no relevant diagnostic module remains.
- Filter Logic: Use previous platform or feature selections to drive targeted follow-ups.

Quality Controls:

- Embed attention checks at approximately a 1:9 ratio.
- Flag respondents completing substantially below the platform median time.
- Detect straight-lining across rating batteries.
- Review open-ended responses for gibberish, duplication, and non-responsive text.
- Use randomisation and counterbalancing to reduce order effects.
- Avoid large grids and use fully labelled 5-point unipolar scales to reduce acquiescence and positive-end response bias among Indian respondents.

You can request a different methodology before generating the survey.

Question Flow & Survey Phases

Phase 1 — Screening & Warm-Up: Confirm recent social-media use, fitness-platform use, workout or fitness-content behaviour, and the respondent's relationship with FitShare or competing platforms. This establishes respondent credibility without re-collecting audience-system demographics.

Phase 2 — Current Usage & Behaviour: Measure platforms used, workout frequency, fitness-content consumption, tracking habits, group or challenge participation, social motivations, notification exposure, and recent changes in screen time.

Phase 3 — Unmet Needs & Digital Wellbeing: Identify unaided frustrations before prompted lists. Cover motivation, consistency, relevance, accountability, privacy, comparison pressure, notification fatigue, distraction, content quality, and desired healthy-engagement controls.

Phase 4 — Sequential Monadic Concept Evaluation: Present the three feature concepts individually in rotated order. Measure appeal, usefulness, relevance, differentiation, understanding, trust, perceived control, FitShare fit, trial likelihood, and one concise reason probe for each concept.

Phase 5 — Feature-Specific Diagnostics: Route respondents to targeted modules based on their strongest interest. Explore AI safety and explainability, live-session format and participation barriers, and marketplace trust, product categories, purchase triggers, and commercial acceptability.

Phase 6 — Roadmap Prioritisation & Close: Capture first choice, least wanted feature, preferred first-use occasion, retention potential, switching barriers, and one open-ended recommendation for improving FitShare.

Break screens may be inserted between major phases if field timing indicates elevated respondent burden. Any break screen will be non-terminal and may use a milestone, spin, or breathing variant.

Key Data Points to Measure

Primary Metrics:

- Social-media and fitness-platform usage incidence - establishes the addressable behavioural base and supports user-status segmentation.
- Platform repertoire and usage frequency - benchmarks FitShare against competing and adjacent platforms.
- Workout frequency and fitness-content engagement - identifies high-intent and lower-engagement audiences.
- Current motivation and consistency barriers - reveals the problems most likely to justify product investment.
- Accountability and community participation needs - determines the role of social interaction in sustained fitness behaviour.
- Notification, privacy, comparison, and screen-time concerns - identifies the risks FitShare must avoid while designing engagement features.
- Concept appeal top-two-box - provides a comparable absolute measure across all three ideas.
- Perceived usefulness and relevance - separates attractive novelty from a solution to a real user problem.
- Differentiation and FitShare fit - indicates whether each feature can create a defensible proposition.
- Trust, safety, explainability, and perceived control for AI - defines adoption safeguards for personalised recommendations.
- Live-session participation intent and barriers - guides group size, trainer involvement, timing, privacy, and accountability design.
- Marketplace purchase openness and product-category interest - tests the commercial opportunity and scope of the marketplace.
- Feature trial likelihood and retention potential - estimates the gap between initial interest and behaviour change.
- First-choice and last-choice feature share - supports roadmap prioritisation and deprioritisation.

Supporting Metrics:

- Current FitShare, competitor, lapsed, and general-user status - supports opportunity sizing by user relationship.
- Fitness goal type - allows comparison of weight management, strength, wellness, performance, and habit-building needs.
- Social motivation profile - identifies users driven by accountability, belonging, competition, inspiration, or private progress.

- AI comfort and desired human oversight - defines the appropriate balance between automation and coaching.
- Preferred live-workout format, timing, group size, and privacy level - supports experience design and scheduling decisions.
- Desired notification and focus controls - supports healthier retention without encouraging unwanted screen time.
- Marketplace trust drivers, disclosure expectations, and price-value perceptions - protects FitShare credibility while testing monetisation.
- Switching barriers and substitution risks - indicates the investment needed to move users from established platforms.

Advanced Analytics We'll Apply:

- Cross-tabulation to compare feature performance by user status, fitness participation, age bracket, city, gender, and NCCS class.
- Segment profiling to identify AI-receptive, accountability-seeking, commerce-oriented, and digital-wellbeing-conscious groups.
- Gap analysis to compare current solutions with unmet needs and desired future experiences.
- Concept scorecard analysis to compare appeal, usefulness, trust, differentiation, trial, and retention potential.
- Forced-choice preference share analysis to identify the feature most likely to win roadmap priority.
- Open-ended thematic and sentiment analysis to identify emotional drivers, adoption barriers, and recommended safeguards.
- Order-effect checks to assess whether concept sequence materially changes evaluations.

Expected Insights & Outcomes

By the end of this study, you will possess the data to:

- Validate whether users value AI workout plans only when they feel personalised, explainable, adjustable, and safe.
- Validate whether live group workouts are most attractive to users who need accountability or social motivation rather than to all fitness users.
- Validate whether marketplace interest depends more on trust, relevance, transparent recommendations, and value than on product availability alone.
- Validate whether lapsed or reduced social-media users respond better to purposeful, wellbeing-oriented engagement than to conventional high-frequency social mechanics.
- Validate whether current FitShare users prioritise improvements that reduce friction in their existing routine.

- Validate whether competitor users require a clearer switching reason before considering FitShare.

Business decisions enabled:

- Decide which feature should enter prototyping first.
- Decide whether the marketplace should be part of the initial product roadmap or treated as a later monetisation layer.
- Decide which AI safeguards, controls, explanations, and human-oversight mechanisms are required before launch.
- Decide which live-workout formats, participation mechanics, privacy settings, and accountability tools deserve development.
- Decide which marketplace categories, trust mechanisms, disclosure principles, and recommendation rules are acceptable to users.
- Decide which engagement mechanisms improve motivation without increasing unwanted screen time or notification fatigue.
- Identify the highest-value user segments for AI coaching, live group sessions, marketplace participation, and digital-wellbeing features.
- Determine the largest unmet needs across current, competitor, lapsed, and general Indian social-media users.

Strategic actions unlocked:

- Prioritise the feature roadmap around the strongest combination of user need, differentiation, trust, and trial potential.
- Define the experience requirements for AI recommendations, live participation, notifications, privacy, and affiliate commerce.
- Develop segment-specific positioning for accountability seekers, personalisation seekers, community users, and wellbeing-conscious users.
- Establish whether FitShare should compete through deeper utility, healthier engagement, stronger community value, or a combination of these benefits.

Key hypotheses being tested:

1. Users will value AI workout plans only when they feel personalised, explainable, adjustable, and safe.
2. Live group workouts will be most attractive to users who need accountability or social motivation.
3. Marketplace interest will depend more on trust, relevance, and transparent recommendations than on product availability alone.
4. Lapsed or reduced social-media users may respond better to purposeful, wellbeing-oriented engagement than conventional high-frequency social mechanics.
5. Current FitShare users will prioritise improvements that reduce friction in their existing routine.
6. Competitor users will require a clear switching benefit before adopting FitShare.

7. Users with stronger digital-wellbeing concerns will prefer meaningful engagement controls over notification-heavy social mechanics.

KPIs to report:

- Unmet-need incidence.
 - Feature appeal top-two-box.
 - Perceived usefulness.
 - Relevance.
 - Differentiation.
 - Ease of understanding.
 - Trust.
 - Perceived control.
 - Fit with FitShare.
 - Trial likelihood.
 - Retention potential.
 - Feature preference share.
 - First-choice and last-choice rates.
 - Segment-level opportunity scores.
 - Key adoption barriers.
 - Desired AI safeguards.
 - Live-workout participation intent.
 - Marketplace purchase openness.
 - Product-category interest.
 - Notification and digital-wellbeing preferences.
 - Qualitative reason themes.
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Methodology See why

We will deploy a 20-25 question, approximately 8-12 minute survey on the SuperJ mobile application and the web to 500 verified Indian respondents over an initial fieldwork period of approximately two weeks.

The study will use a linear U&A opening followed by sequential monadic evaluation of three feature concepts. Each respondent will evaluate all three concepts, with concept order rotated through a Latin Square plan. The module order will be: screening and warm-up, current usage, unmet needs and digital wellbeing, concept evaluations, feature-specific diagnostics, forced prioritisation, and final open-ended feedback.

A sample of 500 provides a practical directional base for total-sample estimates and subgroup

comparisons, with approximately 4-5 percentage-point sampling precision for a proportion near 50% under a simple random-sampling assumption at 95% confidence. Subgroup findings will be treated as directional unless cell sizes are sufficiently large.

The question mix will use behavioural measures, fully labelled 5-point unipolar scales, forced-choice prioritisation, and open-ended probes only at high-value decision points. Demographic targeting will be enforced by the audience system before survey start and will not be re-collected in the questionnaire.

Data Collection Approach: SuperJ mobile application and web panel, with audience targeting enforced before survey start.

Quality Controls: Attention checks, speeder removal, straight-line detection, duplicate-response screening, order-effect monitoring, and open-ended gibberish filtering.

Target Audience See why

The target audience will include Indian adults who use social media or fitness platforms and can describe recent fitness-content, workout, community, or screen-time behaviour. The sample will deliberately include current FitShare users, users of competing fitness or social platforms, reduced or lapsed social-media users, and general Indian social-media users with relevant fitness exposure.

Total Sample Size: 500 respondents

Geographic Focus: Delhi, Mumbai, Bangalore, and Hyderabad. These four major Indian cities provide a focused metro sample for testing digital fitness, social-platform, AI, live-session, and marketplace behaviours without scattering the sample across too many locations.

Demographics:

- Gender: 50% Male / 50% Female.
- Age Range: 18-24, 24-35, and 35-45. The planned distribution is 200 respondents aged 18-24, 200 aged 24-35, and 100 aged 35-45.
- Socioeconomic Class: NCCS A1, A2, A3, B1, B2, and B3, with a broader A/B/C1 spread to capture both premium digital users and value-conscious fitness users.

Behavioral and Psychographic Filters:

- Recent use of at least one social-media or fitness platform.
- Ability to describe recent fitness-content consumption, workout, tracking, community, or challenge behaviour.
- Current FitShare users, competitor-platform users, reduced or lapsed social-media users, and general social-media users with relevant fitness exposure.

- Users who influence or participate in decisions about fitness-app use.
- Variation in fitness participation level, social motivation, fitness goal, digital-wellbeing concern, AI comfort, live-session interest, and openness to purchasing fitness products online.

Screening Criteria:

- Must be aged 18 or above.
- Must have used at least one social-media or fitness platform recently.
- Must be able to describe recent fitness-content or workout behaviour.
- Must have a relevant role in deciding, influencing, or using fitness applications.
- Must not be a professional respondent, duplicate respondent, or unable to complete the survey attentively.

The sample distribution is designed for a practical directional read across the total audience and core behavioural segments. It should be interpreted as a targeted Indian digital-fitness audience rather than a nationally representative population estimate.